Omusula W. Omuholo

PhD Candidate

School of Journalism and Communication

University of Oregon

omusula@uoregon.edu

EDUCATION

PhD Candidate - Communication Studies, University of Oregon, USA. **Sept 2023 to date**

Working Dissertation Title: *Ey indaba yo-bani lena?* "Whose Story is it?": Re-gendering the historical epic Shaka.

Chair – Prof. H Leslie Steeves

Members – Prof. Christopher Chavez, Prof. Biswarap Sen, Prof. Kemi Balogun

Master of Arts - Communication Studies, University of Ghana, Ghana. **Sept 2019**

Thesis: Visa-free movement and intercultural communication: Expectations and experiences of Kenyans in Ghana.

Supervisor: Dr. Gilbert Tietaah

Bachelor of Arts: Communication and Media Technology with IT (Public Relations, major), Maseno University, Kenya **Dec 2014**

RESEARCH INTEREST

Intercultural communication: Cultural foundations of communication; cross-cultural interaction; identity formation in global contexts.

Media & Language Localization: Indigenous language localization; multilingualism in cinema; global media flows and local adaptations.

African Media Studies: Representations of cultural identity in popular media; decolonizing the African gaze; political economy of African film production.

AWARDS & PUBLICATIONS

Best Student Paper	"Wode Maya and the Role of Content Creators in Indigenizing Tourism Advertising in Africa," - International Communication Association (ICA2026) Conference, Cape Town, South Africa.
Publication	Towards a language reconceptualization of education in Africa: A review of the film Otis Janam in 'Local Languages, Global Futures: Language,

Learning, and Sustainability in Africa.' Language Policy in Africa Journal https://bop.unibe.ch/LPIA/index

CONFERENCES

African Studies Association (ASA) as a panellist on the topic 'Filmic Ruptures and Black World-Making: Cinema as Epistemology in African and Afro-Diasporic Contexts' – New Orleans, Louisiana, USA, December 2026

International Communication Association (ICA) Paper presented on 'Wode Maya and the Role of Content Creators in Indigenizing Tourism Advertising in Africa,' - Cape Town, South Africa, June 2026

Society for Cinema and Media Studies (SCMS) Paper presented on 'Reparative Cinema: Shaka iLembe as Cinematic Decolonization and the Re-centering of the African Gaze.' - Chicago, Illinois, USA, March 2026

National Communication Association (NCA) 'Communication for greater regard' 110th annual convention. Paper presented on 'Visa-free movement towards intercultural experiences for African identity.' - New Orleans, Louisiana, USA, November 2024

Vereinigung für Afrikawissenschaften in Deutschland (VAD): 'Reconfigurations Africa – and in African Studies'. Paper presented on 'Towards a language reconceptualization of education in Africa.' Organized by: VAD and hosted by the University of Bayreuth, Germany, Sept – Oct 2024

The African Languages Conference 'African languages challenges and opportunities.' Moderating a panel discussion on 'Language representation of cultural identity in Popular Media'. Organized jointly by: Bolingo Consult-Ghana/Rwanda, The Lingua-Cultura Experience/Cultura Connector-Canada, and Kabod Group-Ghana, in partnership with the African Academy of Languages (ACALAN). Feb 2023, 2024, 2026

TRAININGS

Right to Information (RTI) training for civil society and journalists (demand-side actors). Organized by Friedrich-Ebert-Stiftung (FES Media Africa) (Germany), Centre for Law Democracy (Canada), and Africa Freedom of Information Centre, Uganda. **Aug, Sept 2021**

The Bikozulu Masterclass in Writing and Storytelling, Kenya. Organized by: Jackson Biko, Renowned Kenyan Writer, Publisher, and Author. **Oct, Nov 2021**

TEACHING EFFECTIVENESS

Guest Lecture: 'Gender, Equality, and Representation in the Media', School of Journalism and Communication Studies (University of Oregon), JCOM 201: Making Sense of Media by Prof. Saima Kazmi, Fall 2025

Guest Lecture: 'Identity and Representation in African Films', African Studies - Schnitzer School of Global Studies and Languages (University of Oregon), AFR 215: Introduction to African Studies by Ass. Prof. Mokaya Bosire, Winter 2026

Research Assistantship (School of Journalism and Communication)

Gretchen Soderlund, Spring 2024

Teaching Assistantship

Fall 2023: J100 Media Professions
Winter 2024: J201 Media and Society
Spring 2024: J320 Gender, Media & Diversity
Fall 2024: JCOM201 Making Sense of Media
Winter 2025: JCOM302 Communication Law
Spring 2025: JCOM303 Media Ethics
Summer 2025: JCOM302 Communication Law
Fall 2025: JCOM201 Making Sense of Media
Winter 2026: JCOM202 How Stories Work
Spring 2026: JCOM 351 Advertising & Culture
Fall 2026: JCOM305 Media History

EMPLOYMENT EXPERIENCE

Summer Program Peer Leader, Student Academy to Inspire Learning (SAIL) summer program, University of Oregon, Eugene, USA. **July 2025, 2026**

Responsibilities: Report to SAIL Leads and Administrative Staff; Follow and enforce all SAIL policies, UO/Housing policies, and code of conduct; Create, organize, and assist with facilitating, supervising, and participating in all activities; Create a safe, inclusive, and supportive environment, demonstrate clear and concise communication; Maintain a high level of adaptability and be a team player, effectively collaborate and equally share responsibilities

Language Researcher, Bolingo Communication and Media Consult, Accra, Ghana

Jan-March 2023

Responsibilities: Conducting research using relevant material to produce information, data, and content. Interpreted research findings and maintained and protected electronic databases. Reporting any problems to the relevant stakeholder, writing reports, articles, white papers, and other types of publications from research findings. Delivering presentations when required and taking up any other work-related duties inside and outside the organization.

Virtual Media Assistant: to Dr. Leo Igwe, Board Member at Humanist International, United Kingdom. **Jan 2015 – May 2022**

Responsibilities: Editing and reviewing papers before publishing, revising and editing speeches before conference presentations and organizing media interviews.

Experiential attachment, Millennial Legacy Foundation, Kisumu, Kenya. **Nov – Dec 2018**

Responsibilities: Organization of workshops; creation of culturally multifaceted awareness campaigns of the company's services to the community; participation in workshops as a language translator (English to Luo)

Research and Communications Assistant, Kwame Nkrumah Foundation, Accra, Ghana.

Sept 2017 - March 2018

Responsibilities: Reviewed books and articles, did editorial work, and assisted with administrative tasks.

Experiential attachment, School of Information Science, Moi University, Eldoret, Kenya.

May – Aug 2014

Responsibilities: Program production and radio hosting, news reporting and editing at the University radio station (103.9 MU FM); cooperative representation of the School of Information Science, Moi University at internal and external events.

PROFESSIONAL ASSOCIATIONS

National Communication Association (NCA)	March 2024 – present
Society for Cinema and Media Studies (SCMS)	July 2024 – present
International Communication Association (ICA)	February 2026 – present
African Studies Association (ASA)	March 2026 – present

VOLUNTEER

What is Research? Conference, University of Oregon, Portland, OR **April 2026**

Assisted with conference programming, registration, and logistics to support smooth conference operations.

Program Coordinator, African Heritage Education and Empowerment Community (AFRHEEC) Summer Enrichment Program, Salem, Oregon **July/Aug 2025**

Lead a team of staff and volunteers to further the social-emotional, behavioral, and educational development of a diverse group of youth enrolled in the summer program. Help develop program policies and protocols and refine them based on input and user data. Provide a structured, inclusive summer program environment that is safe and welcoming to youth and families, affirms youth cultural identity and assets, and provides enrichment support for academic achievement, English Language Arts with active learning opportunities, and family engagement. Serve as a role model for a diverse group of youth and communicate high expectations for program staff, volunteers, and participants. Regularly conduct supervision, staff meetings, and onboarding training.

2nd Kwame Nkrumah Pan-African Intellectual and Cultural Festival, Accra, Ghana, Institute of African Studies, University of Ghana **June 2017**

Led communications and supported conference planning, programming, registration, and logistics to ensure the conference ran smoothly.

REFEREES

Available upon request.